

ACTIVITY 2

LEVELS:

Grade 12, University Preparation

COURSES AND EXPECTATIONS:

Canada and World Issues

GC1.04, GC3.01, GC3.02, UC3.02

TASK:

Through a role play, your students will learn about the impact of multi-national corporations on a community.

EXPECTATIONS:

The student will:

- Analyse the impact of the global economy on people.
- Discuss the role of local participation in globalisation.

TIMEFRAME:

40 Minutes

ACHIEVEMENT CATEGORIES:

Knowledge / Understanding

Thinking / Inquiry

Communication

Application / Making Connections

MATERIALS:

Role Cards

VOCABULARY:

Multi-National Corporations



Mystery Jeans Inc.!

Procedure

People take on roles assigned to them and try to think, feel, and act in their roles. Participants are divided into groups of five and each group member is given a role description (See Supplementary Sheet 1). Within their groups each person makes a one-minute presentation on their perspective on the development of a Mystery Jeans Inc. in their community, and then they debate the issue and make a decision. The groups return to the large group to reflect upon the role play and discuss the process and the decisions. (Both "Mystery Jeans Inc." and "Maquila" are fictitious.) For a variation on the game, review the textbox at the end of the instructions.

1. Divide your class into groups of five (If, you do not have 5 members per group, you can participate in one group discussion or increase the number of first and second citizens in some groups), each group is given copies of each of the five role descriptions and told the following:

"You are citizens of a medium-sized and relatively non-industrialized Third World country called Maquila. Your community has been asked to make a decision as to whether or not to permit the large multinational company - Mystery Jeans Inc. - to build a manufacturing plant here. In order to help your country make a decision, introduce yourself to your group in a one-minute presentation using the information provided in your role descriptions. Your presentations should give your opinion on this matter and reasons or facts to support that opinion."

Give the role players five minutes to read their roles and put together their one-minute group introduction.

2. After the presentations each "community" should debate the issue for about 15 minutes.

3. After the debate, the community (each small group) should make a decision on whether or not they will permit the Mystery Jeans Inc. to locate in Maquila. The role-play should run approximately 25 to 30 minutes in total.

4. When all the "communities" have reached a decision, bring the groups back together for the debriefing discussion. Give the participants a few moments to "get out of their roles" with a stretch and a pause; then begin the discussion. Have the groups share their decisions.

1. How did the participants feel in their roles?
2. How did they feel about the decision?
3. Who had power in the community?
4. What was the power?
5. What kinds of things maintained the power?
6. Can you think of any real life situations that resemble the Mystery Jeans Inc. and Maquila?
7. Who are we in that scenario and what role do we play?
8. What can we do about multinationals?
9. What can we do about development?
10. Allow 10 minutes for discussion.

Variation on Mystery Jeans Inc.

As an alternative to having the communities get together and make a decision, have all the specific roles join together to discuss their standpoint and then have a class debate with all community members. For example, all the first citizens can get together and discuss their standpoint on having Mystery Jeans Inc. set up a factory in their community.